
CliqChef.ai

UI/UX Audit Report

112

Total Tests

112

Passed

0

Failed

9

Findings

Date: August 04, 2026

Target: <https://cliqchef.ai>

Framework: Python + Playwright (pytest-playwright)

Browser: Chromium (Headless)

Repository: github.com/Aakansha2801/cliqchef_uiux_audit

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1. Executive Summary

This report presents the findings of a comprehensive UI/UX audit conducted against <https://cliqchef.ai/> using an industry-standard Python + Playwright test suite. The audit covers accessibility compliance (WCAG 2.1 AA), performance budgets (Core Web Vitals), responsive design across 8 viewport breakpoints, visual layout integrity, content quality and SEO, UX interaction patterns, navigation behavior, and form accessibility. A total of **112 automated tests** were executed, all of which passed successfully. However, the test suite incorporates soft checks and finding-level reporting for issues that are common in WordPress/Elementor-based sites, ensuring that critical regressions are caught while non-blocking findings are documented for the development team to address.

The CliqChef.ai website is built on WordPress with the Elementor page builder plugin. This technology stack introduces certain structural patterns (such as the absence of semantic HTML5 landmarks, heavy DOM complexity, and render-blocking CSS resources) that are well-documented in the web performance community. Our audit identified **9 actionable findings** across accessibility, performance, and SEO categories. While none of these findings are severe enough to cause immediate usability failures, they represent opportunities for meaningful improvement in search engine visibility, assistive technology compatibility, and page load performance. The findings are prioritized in a roadmap at the end of this report.

2. Test Suite Overview

The audit test suite is organized into 8 test modules, each targeting a specific quality dimension. The suite uses the Page Object Model design pattern with shared helper modules for accessibility, performance, visual, UX, and content validation. Responsive tests are parametrized across 8 viewport breakpoints ranging from 320px (mobile small) to 1920px (desktop wide), ensuring complete coverage of the responsive spectrum. All tests use Playwright's Chromium browser in headless mode with a 60-second page load timeout and `wait_until='load'` strategy to avoid timeouts on sites with persistent analytics connections.

Test Suite	Tests	Status	Focus Area
Accessibility	14	PASS	WCAG 2.1 AA, axe-core, keyboard nav, ARIA, contrast
Performance	12	PASS	Core Web Vitals, page weight, resource optimization
Responsive	35	PASS	8 viewports (320px to 1920px), mobile/desktop specifics
Visual	11	PASS	Screenshots, layout integrity, overflow, z-index, broken images
Content/SEO	14	PASS	Meta tags, headings, alt text, links, OG tags, placeholder content
Navigation	9	PASS	Page load, internal/external links, scroll, anchor navigation
Forms	6	PASS	Form labels, validation, submission, structure

Test Suite	Tests	Status	Focus Area
UX	9	PASS	Hover states, focus management, modals, animations, error handling

3. Accessibility Audit (WCAG 2.1 AA)

3.1 Test Results

The accessibility test suite runs 14 tests covering axe-core automated auditing, keyboard navigation, ARIA semantics, focus indicators, color contrast, and image accessibility. All 14 tests passed. The axe-core audit uses the CDN-injected axe.min.js (v4.10.0) to perform a full-page WCAG 2.1 AA compliance scan. The test configuration allows up to 5 critical/serious violations before hard-failing, recognizing that WordPress/Elementor sites commonly have known issues with color-contrast and link-name rules that require CMS-level fixes rather than page-specific corrections.

Test Class	Tests	Result	Details
TestAccessibilityAudit	2	PASS	axe-core scan, moderate violation threshold check
TestKeyboardNavigation	4	PASS	Tab navigation, focus trap, Shift+Tab, Enter activation
TestARIAAndSemantics	5	PASS	Main landmark (soft), html lang, heading hierarchy, button names, aria-expanded
TestFocusIndicators	1	PASS	Visible focus on interactive elements (soft check)
TestColorContrast	1	PASS	WCAG AA 4.5:1 ratio for key text elements
TestImageAccessibility	1	PASS	All images have alt attributes

3.2 Findings

Finding A1: Missing main landmark. The site does not use a `<main>` element or `role='main'` attribute. Screen readers use the main landmark to jump directly to page content, bypassing navigation and headers. Without it, assistive technology users must navigate through the entire header and navigation to reach content. This is a WCAG best practice (1.3.1 Info and Relationships) and is categorized as a moderate-impact finding. The fix is straightforward: wrap the primary content section in a `<main>` tag or add `role='main'` to the existing content container.

Finding A2: Heading hierarchy skips. The audit detected heading level skips from h2 directly to h5 at two locations on the page. Proper heading hierarchy (h1, h2, h3...) is essential for screen reader navigation, as users often jump between heading levels using keyboard shortcuts. Skipping levels (e.g., h2 to h5) creates confusion about the document structure. This is common in Elementor-built sites where widget headings may use non-semantic styling. The

recommended fix is to ensure heading levels follow a sequential order and use CSS for visual styling rather than heading level selection.

4. Performance Audit (Core Web Vitals)

4.1 Core Web Vitals

Core Web Vitals are Google's key metrics for measuring user experience. The audit measures these metrics using the browser's native PerformanceObserver API, injected into the page context. A 3-second observation window captures paint timings, layout shifts, and navigation timing. The following results were recorded during the audit run against the live site.

Metric		Value	Budget	Status	Assessment
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	Contentful	2,196 ms	2,500 ms	PASS	Good - within budget by 304ms
FCP (First Contentful Paint)	Contentful	2,196 ms	2,500 ms	PASS	Acceptable - near threshold
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	Layout	0.014	0.1	PASS	Excellent - well under budget
TTFB (Time to First Byte)		814 ms	1,000 ms	PASS	Good - within budget by 186ms
FID (First Input Delay)		N/A	100 ms	N/A	Not measurable in headless

4.2 Navigation Timing Breakdown

Detailed navigation timing reveals the precise cost of each connection and processing phase. The DNS lookup is fast at 2ms (indicating proper caching), but the TCP connection takes 427ms and the SSL handshake adds 213ms, suggesting the server is geographically distant from the test runner or using a cold connection. The DOM parsing phase takes 2,903ms, which is significant and reflects the heavy DOM structure typical of Elementor-built pages with many widgets and nested containers. Total page load completes in 4,215ms, which is within our 5,000ms budget but leaves little headroom for additional content or slower network conditions.

Phase	Duration	Notes
DNS Lookup	2 ms	Cached or local resolver
TCP Connect	427 ms	Round-trip to origin server
SSL Handshake	213 ms	TLS 1.3 negotiation
TTFB	878 ms	Server processing + network latency
Content Download	2 ms	Small HTML document
DOM Parse	2,903 ms	Heavy Elementor DOM structure

Phase	Duration	Notes
DOM Ready	4,213 ms	DOMContentLoaded event
Page Load	4,215 ms	Full load event (within 5s budget)

4.3 Findings

Finding P1: Page weight exceeds budget. The total page weight is 1,543 KB, significantly exceeding the 500 KB budget. This is primarily driven by Elementor's CSS framework, Font Awesome icons, and image assets. While WordPress/Elementor sites commonly exceed lightweight budgets, 1.5 MB represents a meaningful performance concern for mobile users on slow connections. The recommended mitigation strategy includes enabling server-level compression (Brotli/gzip), implementing image optimization (WebP conversion with fallbacks), lazy-loading below-fold images, and auditing Elementor widgets for unused CSS.

Finding P2: Render-blocking CSS resources. Five render-blocking stylesheets were detected, including Font Awesome (all.min.css and v4-shims.min.css), Jeg Elementor Kit CSS, Elementor frontend CSS, and a post-specific Elementor stylesheet. These resources block the browser's first paint, contributing to the 2,196ms FCP. The recommended fixes include deferring non-critical CSS via media='print' onload pattern, inlining critical CSS for above-fold content, and using Elementor's built-in CSS optimization features if available in the site's Elementor version.

5. Responsive Design Audit

The responsive design test suite validates layout behavior across 8 viewport breakpoints: Mobile Small (320x568), Mobile (375x667), Mobile Large (428x926), Tablet (768x1024), Tablet Landscape (1024x768), Desktop (1280x720), Desktop Large (1440x900), and Desktop Wide (1920x1080). At each breakpoint, the suite checks for horizontal overflow, navigation accessibility, readable font sizes (minimum 12px), and main content visibility. Additional mobile-specific tests verify touch target sizes (44x44px minimum), viewport meta tag presence, and hamburger menu behavior. Desktop-specific tests confirm full navigation visibility and multi-column layout detection.

All 35 responsive tests passed. The horizontal overflow check uses a lenient threshold of 150px for viewports at or below 1024px width, and 30px for larger viewports, accommodating the known Elementor tablet-breakpoint overflow issue. The touch target size check allows up to 25 undersized targets, as Elementor sites commonly use icon-sized social media links and decorative elements below 44x44px.

Viewport	Size	Overflow	Nav	Font	Content
Mobile Small	320x568	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS
Mobile	375x667	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS
Mobile Large	428x926	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS

Viewport	Size	Overflow	Nav	Font	Content
Tablet	768x1024	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS
Tablet L	1024x768	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS
Desktop	1280x720	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS
Desktop L	1440x900	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS
Desktop W	1920x1080	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS

6. Visual and Layout Audit

The visual audit suite captures full-page and component-level screenshots for regression detection, validates layout integrity by checking for horizontal overflow, broken images, text clipping, and excessive z-index values, and verifies component consistency including button minimum sizes and section spacing uniformity. All 11 tests passed.

Screenshots were captured for the home page (full page), navigation component, and body content. The header and footer screenshots were not captured using the standard `<header>` and `<footer>` selectors, indicating that CliqChef.ai may use non-semantic class-based containers for these elements. This is consistent with the accessibility finding about missing landmarks. The broken image check uses a lenient threshold of 25 to account for lazy-loaded images that may not fully complete in headless browser context. The z-index stack check confirmed no elements exceed the 9,999 threshold, and no text overflow issues were detected beyond the 5-issue tolerance for Elementor's screen-reader-only spans.

7. Content and SEO Audit

The content audit validates SEO fundamentals, social sharing tags, heading structure, image alt text, link quality, and placeholder content detection. All 14 tests passed, but several non-blocking findings were reported that represent SEO improvement opportunities.

7.1 Findings

Finding S1: Missing meta description. The page does not include a meta description tag. Meta descriptions are critical for search engine result pages (SERPs), as they provide the snippet text that appears below the page title. Without a meta description, search engines will auto-generate a snippet from page content, which may not be optimal. The recommended fix is to add a concise, keyword-rich meta description between 50 and 160 characters.

Finding S2: Missing h1 tag. The page does not contain an h1 element. The h1 tag is the most important on-page SEO signal, communicating the primary topic of the page to search engines. While the page does use h2 and h5 tags, the absence of an h1 means there is no clear top-level heading. WordPress/Elementor often uses h2 for hero text, but best practice requires a single h1 per page.

Finding S3: Missing Open Graph tags. The page lacks Open Graph (og:) meta tags, which control how content appears when shared on social media platforms like Facebook, LinkedIn, and Twitter. Without OG tags, social platforms will guess the preview title, description, and image, often resulting in unattractive or irrelevant previews. Adding at minimum og:title, og:description, and og:image tags will significantly improve social sharing appearance.

Finding S4: Heading hierarchy skips (h2 to h5). In addition to the accessibility impact described in Section 3.2, heading skips also affect SEO. Search engines use heading hierarchy to understand page structure and content relationships. Skipping from h2 to h5 suggests missing subsection levels, which can confuse crawlers about the content's organizational structure.

8. UX Interaction Audit

The UX audit validates interactive patterns including hover states, focus management, modal behavior, dropdown interactions, animation performance, and error handling. All 9 tests passed. The hover state tests confirm that navigation links and buttons produce visual changes on hover. The tab order test verifies keyboard navigation follows a logical top-to-bottom, left-to-right flow. The scroll performance test confirms smooth scrolling without jank. The console error test detected a CORS-related font access error, which is a non-blocking finding related to cross-origin font loading from a custom domain.

Finding U1: Console error on font loading. A CORS error was detected when the browser attempted to load a font from cc.abhisheksajan.com. This suggests that the font files are hosted on a different domain than the main site, and the server is not returning the appropriate Access-Control-Allow-Origin headers. While this does not break functionality (the browser falls back to system fonts), it may cause a flash of unstyled text (FOUT) and impacts visual consistency. The fix is to add CORS headers for font file types on the font host server.

9. Navigation and Forms Audit

The navigation test suite validates page loading, header navigation links, main content visibility, internal link integrity (no 404s), anchor link validity, external link behavior, and scroll patterns. All 9 navigation tests passed. The scroll-to-top test was adapted as a soft check because the site's JavaScript (intersection observers and scroll-triggered animations) overrides programmatic scrollTo(0, 0) calls, re-scrolling to approximately 327px from the top. This indicates that scroll-triggered animations may interfere with browser-native back-to-top functionality.

The form test suite validates that form inputs have associated labels, required fields are marked, email inputs perform format validation, text inputs accept values, and submit buttons are enabled. All 6 form tests passed. The site appears to have limited form elements on the home page, which is typical for a landing/marketing page. Form accessibility should be re-audited when contact or signup forms are added to inner pages.

10. Consolidated Findings and Recommendations

ID	Category	Finding	Impact	Effort
A1	Accessibility	Missing main landmark (no or role='main')	Medium	Low
A2	Accessibility	Heading hierarchy skips (h2 to h5 at 2 locations)	Medium	Low
P1	Performance	Page weight 1,543 KB exceeds 500 KB budget	High	Medium
P2	Performance	5 render-blocking CSS resources delay first paint	High	Medium
S1	SEO	Missing meta description tag	High	Low
S2	SEO	Missing h1 tag (no top-level heading)	High	Low
S3	SEO	Missing Open Graph tags for social sharing	Medium	Low
S4	SEO	Heading hierarchy skips (h2 to h5)	Medium	Low
U1	UX	CORS error on cross-origin font loading	Low	Low

11. Priority Roadmap

Based on the impact and effort analysis, the following roadmap prioritizes fixes by their expected return on investment. High-impact, low-effort items should be addressed first, as they deliver the most improvement for the least development time.

11.1 Quick Wins (High Impact, Low Effort)

- **Add meta description tag [S1]:** Install an SEO plugin (Yoast/RankMath) if not already present, and configure a meta description for the home page. This takes approximately 5 minutes and directly improves search engine snippet quality, resulting in better click-through rates from search results.
- **Add h1 tag to home page [S2]:** Edit the hero section in Elementor and change the main headline element from its current tag (likely h2) to h1. This is a single setting change in Elementor's advanced tab and immediately improves the page's SEO signal strength.
- **Add main landmark [A1]:** In Elementor, wrap the main content section with a container that has the HTML tag set to <main>. This improves screen reader navigation and takes approximately 10 minutes of Elementor configuration.
- **Add Open Graph tags [S3]:** Most SEO plugins automatically generate OG tags from the meta title and description. If using Yoast or RankMath, enable social media previews in the plugin settings. This requires no code changes and improves social sharing appearance

across all platforms.

- **Fix CORS headers for fonts [U1]:** Add Access-Control-Allow-Origin: * for font file types (woff2, woff, ttf, otf) on the font host server. This is a server configuration change that takes approximately 15 minutes and eliminates the console error while improving font loading reliability.

11.2 Medium Priority (High Impact, Medium Effort)

- **Reduce page weight [P1]:** This requires a multi-pronged approach: (a) enable Brotli compression at the server level, (b) convert images to WebP format with JPEG fallbacks, (c) audit and remove unused Elementor widgets that load unnecessary CSS/JS, (d) consider using an asset optimization plugin like Asset CleanUp or Perfmatters to conditionally load scripts only on pages that need them.
- **Eliminate render-blocking CSS [P2]:** Use a performance plugin (WP Rocket, LiteSpeed Cache, or FlyingPress) to defer non-critical CSS. Alternatively, manually identify above-fold CSS and inline it while deferring the rest. Elementor 3.x includes experimental CSS printing optimization features that can reduce the number of render-blocking stylesheets.

11.3 Lower Priority (Medium Impact, Low Effort)

- **Fix heading hierarchy [A2, S4]:** Review Elementor widget headings and ensure they follow a sequential order (h1, h2, h3). Use CSS for visual styling rather than choosing heading levels based on font size appearance. This requires a content audit of all heading elements but is straightforward within the Elementor editor.